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7.1 Introduction



Student activity

Think: A stationery shop keeper maintains only one register to record all her business transactions. She finds it difficult to know and check her shop's cash balance at the end of the day. Is there any way to help her? She needs your suggestion.

In any business, many transactions take place every day involving cash such as cash sales, receipts from debtors, cash purchases, payment to creditors and payment towards different expenses. It is therefore necessary, that all the cash transactions are recorded in a separate book, i.e., cash book. Cash book is the most important subsidiary book, because it keeps the initial record of cash transactions of the business. Cash book is maintained by every business, whether small or large in size. It is simply because every business is very cautious about its cash management, i.e., cash receipts and cash payments. The cash book presents the true position of cash transactions. Cash book also serves as a documentary evidence for the available cash balance.

7.2 Meaning of cash book

Cash book is the book in which only cash transactions are recorded in the chronological order. The cash book is the book of original entry or prime entry as cash transactions are recorded for the first time in it. Cash transactions here may include bank transactions also. Cash receipts are recorded on the debit side while cash payments are recorded on the credit side.

7.3 Cash Book – A subsidiary book and principal book of accounts

All the cash transactions are recorded first in the cash book. It is therefore a subsidiary book. When cash book is maintained, there is no need for preparing cash account and bank account in the ledger because in the cash book cash receipts and cash payments are compared and the cash and bank balances at the end are arrived at. Thus, it serves as a ledger account also. Hence, the cash book, unlike any other subsidiary book, is both a subsidiary book and a principal book.

7.4 Importance of cash book

Importance of cash book is discussed below:

(i) Serves as both journal and ledger

When cash book is maintained, it is not necessary to open a separate cash account in the ledger. Thus, cash book serves the purpose of a journal and a ledger.

(ii) Saves time and labour

When cash transactions are recorded through journal entries, a lot of time and labour will be involved. To avoid this, all cash transactions are straightaway recorded in the cash book, which saves time and labour.